

SANDESH RAVIKUMAR

250-300 companies participating. "Our students are important for us and we give them special skills training. During the pandemic too, we did our level best. The faculty members got trained for one month on online teaching platforms such as WebEx and the students used the platforms very well," the VC says. "We introduced viva-voce exams so we could assess the students better."

This year, Christ admitted more than 14,000 students across all its campuses, including three existing one in Bengaluru (plus the new Yeshwanthpur campus, which will start on August 18) besides one each in Ghaziabad and Lavasa, Pune. The number of applications this year crossed 100,000, up from 80,000 last year. Fr Abraham says the university receives foreign students from 70 countries, though their intake has been lower in the past couple of years due to the pandemic.

The university also focuses on social outreach programmes through its Centre for Social Action—a students' initiative set up in 1999 for social sensitisation programmes such as development projects for marginalised communities. "At least once in three years, the students will be staying in a village. Some of them are seeing a village for the first time," says Abraham. "Social responsibility is one of the core values." ■

by Ajay Sukumaran

NO. 3 KONERU LAKSHMAIAH EDUCATION FOUNDATION (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), *Guntur*

FAST TRACK TO SUCCESS

In four decades, what began as the **Koneru Lakshmaiah (KL) College of Engineering in 1980** has transformed into the KL Education Foundation (deemed to be university) or KLU, with a lush green 100-acre campus at Vaddeswaram, Guntur, on the outskirts of Vijayawada and two others at Moinabad and Bachupally in Hyderabad. It caters to 10,000 students through 10 colleges. In addition, there is a centre for distance and online education. KLU has changed the landscape of education in Vijayawada and the Telugu states.

KLU offers a wide range of undergraduate, postgraduate and research courses in science, law, fine arts, pharmacy, humanities and sciences, management, architecture, agriculture, commerce and new-age disciplines, including animation, gaming, AI, virtual reality, blockchain and cryptocurrency. It also offers PhD programmes in engineering, science and humanities, management, law, and pharmacy. For this, it has 74 academic laboratories, 25

GURUSPEAK

"A consistent upsurge in KLU's wide recognition resonates with our core values of evolution and growth. We aim to bring to students an ever-progressive academic environment"



KONERU SATYANARAYANA, FOUNDER-PRESIDENT, KONERU LAKSHMAIAH EDUCATION FOUNDATION (DEEMED TO BE UNIVERSITY), GUNTUR